Navigating a New World with an Old Set of Charts

Your notes from the session with Caspar Craven. The three questions, the charts I had to redraw, and space to redraw your own.

- **What am I not seeing?**
- **How aligned is our team?**
- **Impossible, or just hard?**

WHERE WE STARTED

You can't navigate a new world using an old set of charts

> **"The pace of change will never be this slow again."**
>
> McKinsey

> **"You don't sail round the world. You sail the next four hours. One watch at a time."**
>
> Ian, Southern Ocean, 2000

You can't deliver transformation with the same thinking that created today's results.

If we do what we've always done, we'll get what we've always got. Which of your charts still holds, and which needs redrawing?

THE BIG QUESTION

How do we make confident decisions in uncertain times, together?

THREE TRANSFORMATIONS, THREE QUESTIONS

1 What am I not seeing?

2 How aligned is our team?

3 Impossible, or just hard?

What am I not seeing?

Leading the fleet, then crashing. We had it the wrong way round: numbers over people, win at all costs. People felt unseen, unheard, unappreciated.

THE OLD CHART

Results first.
Eyes only on the finish line.

THE NEW CHART

People first.
One watch at a time.

Accountability starts with people telling you the truth.

Google studied 180 teams. The best weren't the ones that avoided mistakes. They were the ones where people felt safe enough to admit them early.

QUESTION 1 · THE ONE TO ASK ON MONDAY

"Would you mind telling me something I don't seem to realise?"

Who will you ask, and when? What do you expect to hear?

How aligned is our team?

Going fast and alone, until a friend said: carry on like this and you'll lose all of us. The values conversation I rolled my eyes at was the one that saved the company.

THE OLD CHART

Go fast. Go alone.
I'm right.

THE NEW CHART

Go far. Go together.
How do I know I'm right?

If you want to go fast, go alone. If you want to go far, go together.

South African proverb

THE POWER OF VALUES



Values shape behaviours, behaviours become actions, actions create outcomes. No one succeeds alone: members, suppliers, partners. Together we are stronger.

QUESTION 2

How aligned is your team? Not "are we", which everyone answers yes. How aligned?

Would your members, suppliers and partners describe what matters in the same words?

TONIGHT, ON THE CUTTY SARK

Have one conversation that matters before the night is out.

Ask someone what would make this easier for them.

Impossible, or just hard?

No money, no boat, a wife seasick both times she'd sailed, three crew who hadn't chosen it. Nine reasons it couldn't be done. Every one of them was an opinion until we tested it.

THE OLD CHART

That's impossible.
Shrink the goal.

THE NEW CHART

That's just hard.
Build the capability.

Impossible is usually an opinion, not a fact.

Two tests. Does it defy physics? Has someone, somewhere, done something similar? If no and yes, it's not impossible. It's just hard.

Why	Why not?

Take one decision you have been putting off. Why do it? Why not? Then test each why not.

QUESTION 3

What in your world this year has everyone agreed is impossible?

YOUR TURN

Redraw your chart

The chart you've been sailing by, and the one you'll sail by now. Then one experiment: small enough to start on Monday, clear enough to know if it worked.

MY OLD CHART

MY NEW CHART

THE QUESTION I'LL KEEP ASKING

- What am I not seeing?
- How aligned is our team?
- Impossible, or just hard?

My next experiment

On Monday I'll tell my team

How I'll know it worked

Commit to it at **bigboldgoals.com/ipg** and I'll check in with you.